

OREGON CITY COURIER

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THAT EXPERT

Considerable criticism has been directed against an editorial recently appearing in these columns, in which the thought was expressed that in turning down the chance to get a federal agricultural expert in this county, owing to a fear of increased taxes, the people opposing the expert were "penny wise and pound foolish." A number of correspondents have called specific attention to some of the foot recommendations of so-called experts from state colleges and from commercial clubs; and the idea seems to prevail that a federal expert would be no better.

The Courier holds no brief for federal agricultural experts, and if the people of this county, or the members of the grange, think that a federal expert would not be worth his salt, we presume that one will not be employed. However, the Courier has had some experience with the Agricultural Department of these United States, and it has been our observation that most of the employees of this branch of Uncle Sam's service know their business. It is certainly an undisputed fact that the Agricultural Department has ever been a friend and aid of the farmers of this nation, and that the department has done much to make farming a successful business.

Believing this, the Courier naturally thought that the employment in this section of an agent of this department would be a boon to progressive farmers—who are always willing to admit that they might learn something they didn't know before. The per capita increase in taxes that would result from the employment of such an expert would be a fraction of a mill, and a very small fraction at that. Hence the Courier failed to see the logic in the declaration that the employment of such a man would make taxes too high.

However, the Courier has no desire, as some correspondents seem to think, to force an expert upon the county or upon the grange, or upon individual farmers. Any farmer who wants the helpful suggestions of the Department of Agriculture, and who isn't in a hurry about getting them, can have them by spending two cents and sending a letter to Washington. Maybe the individual expenditure of two cents would please the progressive farmers better than the addition of a fraction of a mill to their taxes—if so, the Courier trusts that they will settle the thing that way.

If it is settled that way, farmers who feel sure that their crop-management could not be improved, and farmers who are sure that they know it all, will not be burdened with any additional outlay; nor will they be bothered by the appearance in this county of a gentle and kindly man, who knows how to make potatoes better, or how to increase the yield of corn, or how to easily prevent red ants from eating the blackberries.

Not to be at all personal, we know of a certain man—he is not a farmer—in this county who thinks he knows how to raise chickens. He has spent approximately \$700 a year for the last three years trying to increase the number of eggs he gets from his fowls. And each year he has had fewer and fewer eggs. It is just barely possible that if this man didn't think he knew so very much about chickens, and asked his Uncle Sam for a little advice, he might learn that mere numbers of chickens had nothing to do with the amount of eggs he could get. He might learn that chickens running wild in the woods were not the kind that laid marketable eggs in record breaking quantities. He might learn a number of things. But he would rather go his way, and spend his money, and try out his own theories. He would strenuously object to the employment of a federal chicken expert. That is his privilege—and he is doing the best he can to exercise it. But he isn't making money.

The Courier—to get away from chickens, and back to the subject—thought it was advertising Clackamas county farmers for the best when it ventured to print that "penny wise and pound foolish" editorial. Apparently quite a number of the farmers didn't think so. The Courier is sorry it offended them; it is sorry some of them thought this paper was

allied with "the powers that be," and that it delighted to see the taxpayers' money squandered. It hopes the farmers—whom it counts as its friends—will not take this view; and that they will believe this paper is just as sincere in its opinions as they are in theirs. And hoping this, the Courier again remarks that it thinks the employment of a federal agricultural expert hereabouts would result in gains in farmers' profits that would more than offset any increase in taxes that the salary of the expert might bring about. In saying this the Courier wants it distinctly understood that it is talking about a federal expert; and not about some bright young man just graduated from a summer-course at Corvallis.

SUPERB WORK

The Courier this week desires to modestly add its little bit to the magnificent campaign of publicity that has been launched by the Hon. George C. Brownell, with the assistance of the Rev. T. B. Ford, the Hon. Christian Schuebel, the Anti-Saloon League's state figurehead, and others. Even the council of Oregon City has entered the game of helping George, for last week they discovered that while George had been mayor of Oregon City he had signed and approved an ordinance prohibiting minors from entering pool halls. The W. C. T. U. had been trying for a long time to get the present council to do this—and it was the Hon. Christian Schuebel who discovered and announced that George had already done it.

It appears that now that George has started to "come back" that his luck simply cannot be beaten. He is like Roosevelt in that respect, things always break so as to give him the center of the stage. When he started rapping the "dry" law he never expected to receive the gratitude of the W. C. T. U.; yet here bobs up this old pool hall ordinance that he put thru, and it is just what the good ladies have been trying to get. And George is the man who made the ordinance effective before it was forgotten. Now that it has been resuscitated and ordered enforced after its long slumber, gratitude to George will flow from the heart of every mother who formerly hummed to herself in the evening that old tune "Where is my wandering boy tonight?"

You have got to hand it to George for brains. Without a press agent other than himself, he has got right into the center of the Enterprise almost every day, just as if Orton Goodwin, the British marvel who worked for the dries, was handling his stuff. It is fine work—it reminds one of Thomas Lawson's efforts. First he took a fall out of an imaginary prohibition law which he said the voters hadn't expected the legislature to pass. Then he let people try to set him right—and look at the assistance he has had. Everybody, even the Enterprise, has fallen for him. Once the Enterprise printed one of his letters on an inside page, and next day they printed it over again on the front page—at George's request.

Can you beat that? And do you wonder that the Courier modestly tries to get in the procession, too? We'd do anything for George—almost.

NOT IN OUR LINE

The Courier is always glad to do favors for its friends, but there are some things that it must tearfully regret to undertake. And one of these is acting as a collection agency. There are a number of collection agencies in the county seat, and the Courier doesn't see how it can very well or gracefully try to compete with them. And aside from that, we have our own troubles.

These remarks are offered here because within the last week this paper has been favored by two letters, each of them asking it to collect money for its busy readers. One man wrote in that he was so busy running a grocery store that he'd appreciate our aid in rounding up a creditor; and the other letter was from a blacksmith who wanted somebody to pay him for two horseshoes.

We'd be tickled to death to oblige; but our chief business is publishing a newspaper and doing good job print-

ing. In our spare time we split wood for the family, help the wife wash dishes, read George C. Brownell's letters, go to the movies, listen to the council save the taxpayers' money and occasionally we go away by our selves and figure out how nice and prosperous it is to try to please each individual one of our 3896 subscribers.

So while we'd like to oblige, we beg to be excused from collecting any bills but our own.

QUITE AS USUAL

Last week, with Councilman Templeton's assistance, Oregon City's city dads resumed their practice of "transacting city business." Among other things they passed Mr. Templeton's "public utility vehicle ordinance" which he admitted in debate was framed in the interest of the Portland Railway, Light & Power company, and the chief purpose of which is to make it impossible for Portland-Oregon City jitneys to enjoy traffic between the county seat and the metropolis. Part of the frame-up concerned with slipping the Templeton ordinance over was the heading towards Earl D. Van Auker of an exclusive franchise to run jitneys in Oregon City as he may feel like it for the next five years.

The Templeton ordinance is just a jumble of words, for the official publication of which the city has paid the usual rate, and which will have no effect on the jitneys from Portland at all—that is, it will be found futile if the outside jitney men use their heads. There are so many loopholes in the ordinance that it would be tiresome to catalogue them—but perhaps the most glaring is that provision which stipulates that the ordinance shall not apply to sight-seeing cars.

pears—though such compensation may consist of doing a public service, such as laying gas mains, maintaining a portion of street paving, or some such matter. Running a jitney once a day every two months is hardly to be considered "compensation," yet as a matter of fact that is all that the Van Auker franchise requires.

A lot of bunk was spilled in the council in regard to the need of "regulating" the jitneys. The Van Auker ordinance doesn't even pretend to regulate the Van Auker jitney, other than to say it ought not to go more than two months without running. It provides no maximum fare, no schedule, no limit to its capacity—in short it provides nothing but that Mr. Van Auker must accept its provisions in writing.

And all this, mind you, is city business. Once again, the Courier begs leave to ask: WOULD ANY COUNCILMAN TRANSACT HIS OWN BUSINESS THE WAY THE COUNCIL TRANSACTS CITY BUSINESS?

SWEET CHARITY

In Chicago a new kind of charity organization has been proposed as being organized with Judge McKenzie Cleland at its head. As announced in The Day Book, one of the local dailies, the new organization will distribute relief without bothering about worthiness of applicants. The fact that a person is in need is all the information it will require.

The plan is to have an agent residing in each precinct of the city's poor districts. This agent is to become personally acquainted with the residents, and upon his knowledge of their affairs the society will depend to keep itself from being imposed upon. It would seem not unfair to describe the plan as the charity methods of Tam-

chester 44 which will kill at two or three hundred yards is just as good for a hunter as the Savage, Marlin or Winchester which shoots a 25 or 30 calibre slug, with half a pint of smokeless in swelled cartridge back of it, and capable of killing at a distance of two miles, or a mile and a half further than any hunter can see.

He is all right up to half a mile, for he can see that far, but what happens in the other mile and a half he don't know, nor does any one until the bullet is stopped by some other hunter or some unoffending person who did not know that a crazy man was loose with such a weapon.

The law ought to take cognizance of this weapon of destruction, and prescribe in exact terms and under heavy penalty who can use it, and where and when. There should go with this use a categorical interview with some one who knows the difference between a careful hunter and one who knows nothing about how to handle a gun of this kind, and the latter should not be allowed under any circumstances to have on. Those who do have the gun should be made to pay a heavy license for using it. They should be taxed the full amount of all such guns they own, and the full penalty of a stringent law should be visited on him every time his gun goes off and kills some one not intended.

Guns of this type may be all right to kill men with, when you want to kill them, but for any other purposes they should not be used and if they are used then the user should be surrounded with every liability which can be devised, so that he may learn to be careful and not expose others to his carelessness.

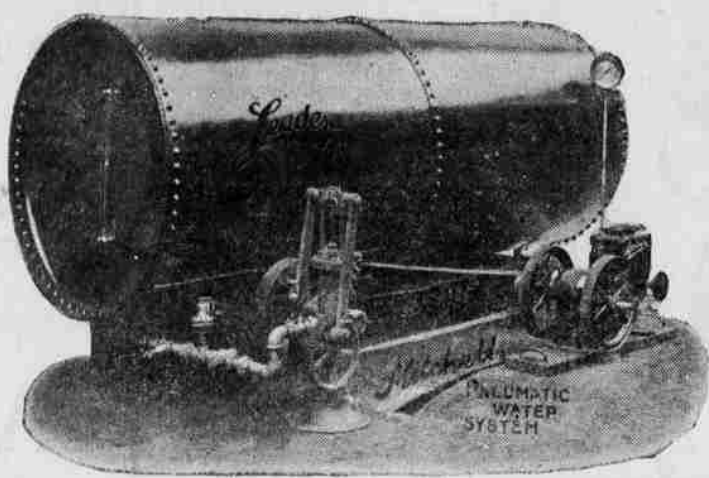
The law is not strong enough in this particular, and should be made adequate to protect harmless persons who do not know that some fool is in

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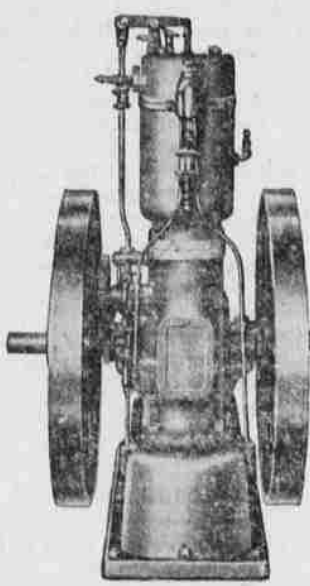


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majority of which was known to oppose prohibition—to play horse with the intent and expression of the voters and make it a CRIME to produce in Oregon what they declared was LEGAL to CONSUME here.

Funny as a dog fight at a prayer meeting, isn't it?

You are welcome to your own idea as to why the joker was put over, also as to who put it over. We have the same privilege, and here is ours:

The Anti-Saloon League didn't want Oregon to go dry at once, for when a state really goes dry this organization loses its job.

This organization wants another state-wide campaign on the issue—and the present half-breed prohibition law insures it. But aside from all this, the results have been worth while.

The saloons are banished, and the saloons are where the most of the drunks are made.

We have considerable confidence in Mr. Brown. We know, as every reader of the Courier knows, that under his regime this paper was one of the "driest" things in Clackamas county. Mr. Brown fought for prohibition in every way that he could; and he fought so thoroughly with the Courier that he lost considerable "wet" business on account of it. So there is no challenging his earnestness in the matter.

And we believe he is just as earnest when he says that the Anti-Saloon League had something to do with the passage of the Oregon "dry" law as it now stands—a law that does not mean prohibition, though it does mean the closing of the saloon, and so a great lessening of the liquor traffic. And there are a lot of other prohibitionists who think that the so-called Anti-Saloon League had a finger in the pie during the last campaign. Not only are there some prohibitionists who think so, but there are some "wets" who think so. And strange as it may seem, the "wets" really know more about what went on in the prohibition camp than the "dries" themselves knew.

It will be remembered that the Anti-Saloon League was never in harmony with the Committee of One Hundred, which handled the major part of the work in the statewide campaign for the dries. The Anti-Saloon League leaders in Portland even issued a statement at one time during the campaign, in which they stated explicitly that they were not in sympathy with the plans of the Committee of One Hundred or its campaign. Yet the Committee of One Hundred was fighting to close the saloon—and did close the saloons; a whole lot of them have closed already.

In view of all this, we hope that in October, when Mr. Hutton, present big chief of the Anti-Saloon League arrives here for his meeting in the Baptist church, that he will be able to explain—and will take time to explain—two things:

First: If Mr. Hutton is as satisfied with the law as he says he is, how does he square his prohibition conscience with the two-quarts-of-booze-and-24-quarts-of-beer clause?

Second: If he is not satisfied with the law, how does he square himself for defending it at this time?

Remarks along these lines from the Anti-Saloon League leader would be far more interesting to us prohibitionists than an evening devoted to the legal fine-points of the law, and what George C. Brownell thinks of them.

Did you ever give the Courier a trial on your stationery? You will find that they have the most up-to-date faces of type and are right there with the punch in getting up a suitable design that will please you—and please others.

Wolf Howls

Forty-five more girls were born in Clackamas county during the months of April, May and June than the number of women who died. This shows two things; that the population is increasing, and that the county is rapidly becoming more and more girlish. With practically twice as many girls as boys being born, how long will it be before we are all girls?

But at that, it is a good sign. Scientists tell us that when the stork wings his way round, looking for chimneys down which to drop babies, that nine times out of ten he drops a girl down into the rich man's house; and eight times out of ten he drops a boy in the poor man's chimney. In other words, well-to-do people run to girls, and folks who are broke have a habit of having boys. With twice as many girls as boys being born about here, it looks as if we were a pretty prosperous section.

Delving still further into the matter of vital statistics, we discover that during the third quarter of the year 33 men died, and only 20 women got tired enough of life to quit it. What does this show—that the women make it hard for men to live here, or that women like the place so much they simply can't bear to leave it?

Having previously remarked that women had cleaner minds than men, and also having remarked that they wore their stockings longer than men; we will now add some more information to the general total. Men and women always put on the left stocking last. If you don't believe this, try it yourself, and see. (Explanation of this joke for John Stark: no matter which stocking you put on first, one of them is left, and you put that one on last.)

Corvallis newspapers inform us that Senator Walt Dimick, upon his return from a month in the wilds, wouldn't leave the college town until he had persuaded a barber to shave off his beard. We wonder why Walt didn't want to come home looking like a pioneer?

More trouble for the average man. The United States has decided that every cheque drawn in excess of the bank balance of the drawer must carry a war tax stamp. What's the trouble with Uncle Sam—doesn't he think that man who overdraws his account has trouble enough?

Some folks would say the preceding paragraph was written in mighty poor English, because the word "trouble" occurs three times. It was written that way on purpose, for it is a troublesome subject.

People who noticed that only three councilmen admitted being readers of the Oregon City papers, when asked at the last council meeting, probably thought the other six councilmen were telling the truth. But they weren't. Anybody around any local newspaper office can tell you that the councilmen all read the local papers; and they are so interested in the Courier that a whole lot of them send friends around every Thursday afternoon to get the paper before the ink is dry.

Out near Mt. Angel last Sunday night a young man and a young woman were driving along a woodland road, when the horse shied at a passing bicycle, with the result that the

(Continued on Page 6)



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